

French A1 — Week 6 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 6

Theme: Food, Cafés, and Restaurants

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 6 takes you into one of the most practical — and most French — scenarios there is: the café. You will learn to order confidently, navigate a restaurant menu, and hold a basic conversation with a waiter in French.

You will also learn partitive articles: the little words (*du, de la, de l', des*) that French uses where English just says "some" — or nothing at all. They show up constantly in food contexts and will become second nature by the end of the week.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 6

By the end of Session 12, you should be able to:

At a café:

Bonjour. Je voudrais un café crème et une tartine, s'il vous plaît. Merci.

At a restaurant:

Bonsoir. Nous voudrions une table pour deux. ... Je vais prendre le menu à vingt euros. Pour l'entrée, je prends la salade, et comme plat principal, je voudrais le poulet. Est-ce que vous pouvez me recommander un dessert? ... L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

Expressing preferences:

J'adore le fromage. Je mange du fromage tous les jours. Mais je ne mange pas de viande — je suis végétarien.

And answer spontaneously:

- Qu'est-ce que vous prenez? — Je voudrais un thé vert, s'il vous plaît.*
- Vous prenez du dessert? — Non merci, je ne prends pas de dessert.*

Partitive Articles — "Some" in French

English often says "I want coffee" with no article. French always makes the "some" explicit:

French says	Instead of	Used before
Je veux du café.	—	masculine noun
Je veux de la bière.	—	feminine noun
Je veux **de l'*** eau.	—	noun starting with vowel or silent h
Je veux des croissants.	—	any plural noun

The negation rule — the most important grammar point this week:

After *ne...pas*, all four forms collapse to **de** (or **d'** before a vowel):

- *Je prends du café.* → *Je ne prends **pas de** café.*
- *Il mange de la tarte.* → *Il ne mange **pas de** tarte.*
- *Elle boit de l'eau.* → **Elle ne boit ****pas d'*eau.***

There are no exceptions. After negation: always *de*.

Je Voudrais — Your Most Important Phrase This Week

Je voudrais means "I would like." It is polite, natural, and used constantly in French cafés and restaurants.

Technically it is a conditional form — a tense you will study fully in A2. For now, treat it as a fixed phrase.

- *Je voudrais un café, s'il vous plaît.*
- *Je voudrais de la tarte.*
- *Nous voudrions une table pour deux.*

You can also say *je vais prendre...* (I'll have...) or *je prends...* (I'm having...). All are correct; *je voudrais* is the most polite.

The Menu vs. La Carte

One false friend to learn now:

French	What it means
le menu	A <i>fixed-price</i> meal deal (starter + main, or main + dessert, or all three at a set price)
la carte	The full list of individual dishes you can choose from
le plat du jour	The dish of the day — usually the best value

When a French person says "*Je vais prendre le menu*," they mean the set meal — not that they want to look at the menu. If you want to see the menu, ask: "*Vous avez la carte?*"

And: **l'entrée in French = the starter, not the main course.** The main course is *le plat principal*.

Vouloir — Key Conjugation This Week

Subject	Vouloir
je	veux
tu	veux
il / elle / on	veut
nous	voulons
vous	voulez

ils / elles	veulent
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Je voudrais is derived from *vouloir* — the conditional form you will learn in A2. Learn it now as a fixed phrase.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 11 — before Session 12:

1. **Say the partitive forms aloud.** *Du café, de la bière, de l'eau, des croissants.* Then say the negatives: *Pas de café, pas de bière, pas d'eau, pas de croissants.*
2. **Write your café order.** What would you order at a French café right now? Write it using *je voudrais*.
3. **Say it out loud.** Third try: no notes.

After Session 12 — before Session 13:

1. **Write a mini restaurant dialogue.** 6–8 lines. You are the customer; write both sides.
 2. **Practice the bill-asking phrase.** *L'addition, s'il vous plaît.* Say it ten times. It should be automatic.
 3. **Learn one food item that surprises you.** Why is *une entrée* a starter? Why is *le menu* not just the menu? Cultural knowledge matters.
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A Note on Mistakes This Week

Two mistakes are very common — and very correctable:

1. **Forgetting to change partitive to *de* after negation.** You will say "*pas du café*" at some point. Your instructor will correct it every time. After a few corrections, it sticks.
2. **Saying *je veux* instead of *je voudrais*.** Both are grammatically correct, but *je veux* sounds blunt in a formal setting. In class you can use either; in a real French café, *je voudrais* is the better habit.

Neither of these is a big deal. The goal this week is to get through a real café or restaurant interaction in French. Everything else is refinement.

Crescere — French A1 Week 6 | Questions? Contact your instructor.